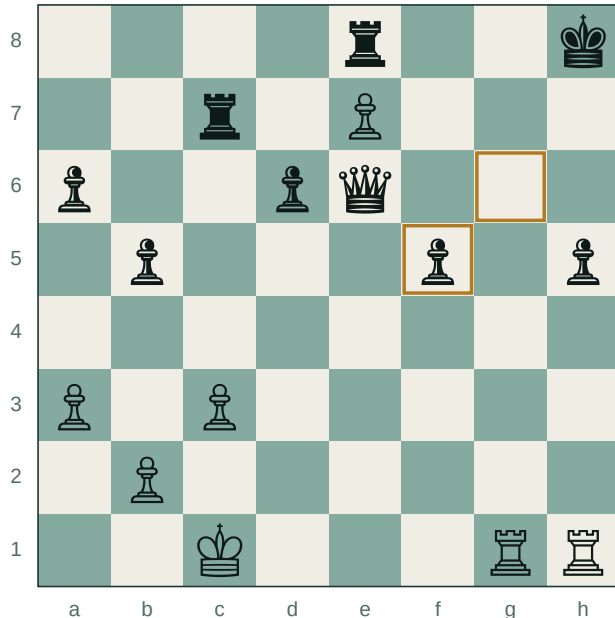


# Queen-and-rook endings: White, move 30

Queen-and-rook endings

White to move



Previous move: 29...gxf5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

## 30. Rxh5+ Qh6+ 31. Rxh6#

**30.Rxh5+** Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the pawn on h5. Recorded reply: **30...Qh6+**.

**31.Rxh6#** Mate: rook on h6 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

### CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on h6. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

### CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

### WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

### HOW TO LOOK

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on h8. Absolute pin: pawn on h5.